

Build your veteran gameplan

Fill this out together, then use it to look up and verify each item with official sources. This is a planning & education worksheet - not the VA, and not legal, medical, or financial advice.

Part 1 · About you

Name

Age range

State of residence

Branch of service

Service era / years

Current status (active / transitioning / veteran / retired / family)

VA disability rating (optional)

Employment situation

Housing situation

How urgent does this feel?

Part 2 · Your top 3 goals (circle up to three)

☐ Transition out of service

☐ Get a better job

☐ Use my education benefits

☐ Buy a home

☐ Start a business

☐ Understand the disability process

☐ Prepare for retirement

☐ Move to a new state

☐ Get my documents organized

☐ Find local veteran support

Part 3 · Your 30 / 60 / 90-day action plan

Next 30 days - the most urgent, time-sensitive steps

Days 31–60

Days 61–90

Part 4 · Documents to gather

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ DD-214 | ☐ Certificate of Eligibility (education / home loan) |
| ☐ Service medical records | ☐ VA award / rating letters |
| ☐ Current treatment records | ☐ Awards, certificates, licenses |
| ☐ Resume | ☐ Other: _____ |

Part 5 · Official sources to verify (write notes as you check each)

VA benefits (health, disability, education, home loan): VA.gov · www.va.gov

Notes: _____

Free accredited claims help: your county veteran service officer, or a VSO (VFW / American Legion / DAV)

Local contact: _____

Employment: DOL VETS & your state American Job Center · dol.gov/agencies/vets

Notes: _____

Business: SBA veteran resources / Boots to Business · sba.gov

Notes: _____

State benefits: your state Department of Veterans Affairs (find via nasdva.us)

Notes: _____

In crisis? The Veterans Crisis Line is free, confidential, and 24/7 - dial **988** then press **1**, or text **838255**.

Facilitator guide - running the session

For the person walking a veteran (or a group) through this worksheet. Goal: everyone leaves with 3 goals chosen and at least three concrete next steps written down.

Suggested 30-minute flow

0–5 min	Welcome & frame it: “This isn’t the VA telling you what you qualify for - it’s a way to leave today with a written plan you can act on.”
5–12 min	Part 1 & 2: fill in the basics and circle up to 3 goals. Encourage picking what feels most urgent, not everything.
12–22 min	Part 3: for each goal, write 1–2 things to do in the next 30 days. Keep steps small and specific.
22–28 min	Parts 4 & 5: note which documents to find and which official source to verify each item with.
28–30 min	Close: name the single first step for this week, and who to contact for free accredited help.

Discussion prompts

1. What’s the one thing you wish someone had handed you when you left service?
2. Of your three goals, which one, if solved, makes the others easier?
3. What’s stopped you from acting on this before - time, trust, or not knowing where to start?
4. Who in your life should have a copy of this plan and your key documents?
5. Would a tool like VetPath help - and what would make you trust it (or not)?

Ground rules to say out loud

• We don’t confirm eligibility - official sources do. • Accredited VSO help is **free**; never pay for basic claims assistance. • This is education and planning, not legal, medical, or financial advice.

VetPath is a planning & education tool - not the VA, a law firm, or an accredited claims representative. Benefit details referenced here were checked against official sources, and rules change - confirm through official sources before relying on them. VetPath does not guarantee any benefit or eligibility.